

melaniesummerfortresslearningedit

(0:00 - 2:57)

Travel Radio Australia and we're at the Australian and New Zealand Disaster Management Conference and I have with me from Fortress Learning, Melanie Sommer. Melanie, you're one of the keynote speakers here and thank you very much for giving us some time. That's my pleasure, Geoff.

It's nice to be here. Now, Fortress Learning, you train the trainers basically, don't you? Tell us about what you do. That's exactly right.

Train the trainers is what most people know it as. It's the qualification people need to either work in an RTO and train, but emergency services use these qualifications a lot because it's a guarantee for assessing people in particular and making sure that they're actually qualified, competent to go on the job. Now, emergency services and disaster management is such a big part of your operation.

Tell us how some of the details about that. Yeah, we actually specialize on emergency services in Australia. We love working with volunteers.

We love what's behind it because let's be honest, they make sure that all of us Australians are safe and it's a hard qualification to get through, not because it's very difficult, but it's very long. It's government regulated. So a lot of people give up on it when they're halfway through and we sort of specialize on getting them through and making sure that the completion rates are above average.

And once they have this qualification, what sort of areas can they move into? So the volunteers, often we work with volunteers and they work like SES, fire, the rural fires, the self-life saving people. So all these agencies use that. So they then train the volunteers or they train others.

But also if someone has the of training and assessment, they can then go and train in their vocational expertise in any industry, whatever they know, they can then train in registered training organizations. And where are you guys based in Australia? We're actually Australia-wide. We are one of those modern companies where everyone works from home.

When we do face-to-face, we'll send trainers out to locations, but generally a lot of our training is done online and therefore we're pretty flexible also to reach people in rural. We're not just, you know, you don't have to go to Brisbane or Melbourne or Sydney. You can literally do it wherever.

What's your area of expertise? How did you get to get into this role, Melanie Sommer? Yes, how did you start off with Fortress Learning? And where did you come from before that? Well, I have a big business background. I have owned and managed and founded various businesses. I'm a

Harvard graduate.

I love business. And so business as Fortress Learning, I took over from someone who had lost the passion. And so I've been with the Fortress Learning team for the last five years and loving it.

(2:57 - 3:05)

What are your impressions of this conference? It looks fantastic. It's the Australia-New Zealand Disaster Management Conference. And tell me about your impressions.

(3:06 - 3:40)

Yeah, I love the variety of people that are here from so many different areas and they all come together. And clearly when you're in this field of expertise in this area, you're so passionate about helping other people. And that really shines through with this.

Like the people are just wonderful and warm. And how can people find out more about Fortress Learning online, Melanie? So our website is fortresslearning.edu.au or otherwise we also on LinkedIn, my personal profile on LinkedIn, they're always finding us. Thank you so much for being part of the program at Travel Radio Australia.

Thank you, Jeff.